IGCSE Environmental Management

One year Intensive Course 2026

Environmental Management (EM) is the study of environmental processes and systems. EM involves managing these systems and human activity influences on them. We consider the benefits humans get from 'nature', the impacts of humans on their environment and how to manage these impacts more sustainably.

This course will be teaching the new 2027-2029 syllabus which covers a broad range of aspects from environmental studies. These topics are generally accessible, engaging and relevant to students which makes EM ideal for those starting their secondary education, those with an interest in the natural world or the sciences, or those wishing to complement other studies with broader understanding of global systems

Key course information

Course Length:	12 month course (46 lessions)
Lesson length:	1 hr 30 mins (including 5 minute break)
Lesson time:	Monday 10am-11.30am
Start date:	Monday June 15th 2026
Finish date:	Monday May 31st 2027
Course price:	£30/month for 12 months OR £360 for full course
Class size:	Maximum 16 students
Exam board:	Cambridge
Course code:	**0680**
Assessment:	Written assessment: two x 1hr 45 min papers

About the 2027-29 syllabus

The existing EM syllabus will be familiar to learners but from 2027 onwards exams will assess the updated content from the 2027-2029 syllabus.

The new syllabus follows the same major themes as the existing courses but in a slightly restructured fashion. For those of you who have been studying already, much of the content will be familiar

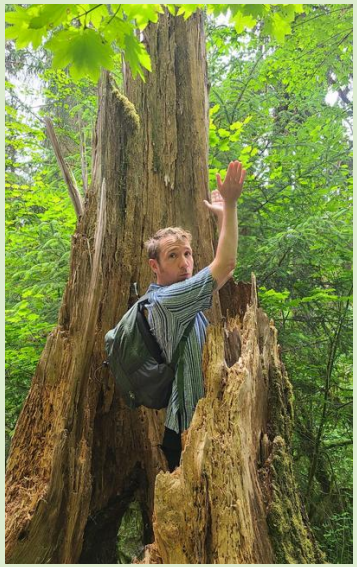
It also includes some emerging environmental challenges and increased focuson practical skills and scientific investigation.

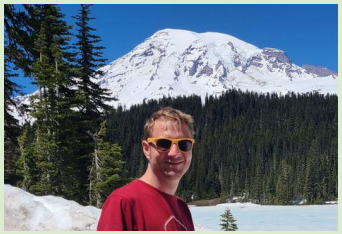
For those of you who have already been studying Environmental Management, you don’t need to start from scratch - there are just some more elements you will need to add!

Modules of study - unit breakdown	
Unit 1: Natural Resources	• Formation of rocks • Extraction and management of mineral resources • Use and management of energy resources
Unit 2: Land	• Soils and crop growth • Food production and crop yield • Soil erosion
Unit 3: Water	• Water sources and supply • Water pollution and disease • Plastic and oil pollution • Marine aquaculture
Unit 4: Atmosphere and human activities	• Atmospheric composition • Climate change • Acid rain and ozone depletion
Unit 5: Ecosystems, biodiversity and fieldwork	• Ecosystem processes • Forest ecosystems • Managing biodiversity and fieldwork
Unit 6: Natural hazards	• Earthquakes and volcanoes • Tropical storms • Flooding and drought
Unit 7: Human population	• Population density, distribution and structure • Managing human populations

Tutor and teaching style

- I'm Damian and I teach all the classes at Earthlings Learning.
- I began my career in education teaching English as a foreign language, where I taught for ten years in Europe and Asia to all ages and abilities.
- I completed a Masters degree in Environmental Management in 2018 (Distinction) and started Earthlings in 2021 to help provide the early career environmental learning I wish I'd had earlier in life.
- Classes are hosted with an informed but informal enthusiastic style, endeavouring to make content as simple and engaging as possible.
- I'm an amateur ecologist, general nature nerd and interested in a wide range of weird and wacky aspects of our planet and its people.
- Students are encouraged to bring any relevent experiences of their own to the classroom. Tangents may occur and are encouraged.
- I enjoy participating in community environmental projects in whatever spare time teaching and my own miniature human allows!





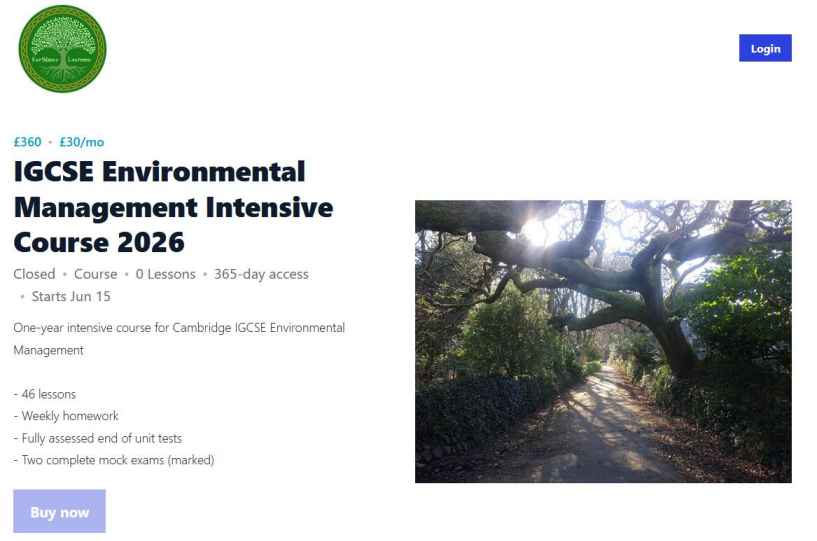
General Course Information

- This course is a complete programme to sit the Environmental Management IGCSE. It is also suitable for those just wanting to learn more about the Earth and human systems.
- While homework is not mandatory it is really important for consolidating knowledge and helping me assess progress. Failure to complete homework may result in a lower grade.
- Participation is optional. Students may engage as little or as much as they are comfortable with. Engagement with groupworking tasks is excellent practice, and engagement from students helps me with the class dynamic but is at all times optional.
- Special Education Needs are more than welcome. We're all different and have different learning styles. Having gone through mainstream education as a "neurospicy learner" and struggled, I endeavour to be as engaging as possible, using as many different mediums to engage with students as I can (pictures, speaking, writing, physical movement)
- CONTENT WARNING - As a GCSE this course is designed for students aged 14 and over. Younger students are welcome but should be aware of some mature content. These topics are approached in a lighthearted and impartial manner but sensitive students should be prepared to examine some of these issues:

1) Agriculture and fishing involve the exploitation and consumption of animals.
2) Natural disasters involves death and disruption to human communities and wildlife.
3) Climate change and biodiversity loss can cause some anxiety in conscientious students.
4) Human population involves discussion of reproduction and population management.

Recording and payment hosting

- To streamline payments for both parents and myself, the course content will be hosted on the online platform Podia.
- Using the secure payment portal, payments can be made in full or paid monthly.
- Recordings and homework can be accessed on this platform and will be available for 12 months following the end of the course



Link: https://earthlingslearning.podia.com/environmental-management-intensive-course-2026

Homework and assessment

- This course combines guided self-assessment and teacher-graded homework to maximise opportunities for content retention, assessment of progress and to teach self-study skills.
- Weekly homework provided.
- Students will be taught how to self-assess weekly homework, with exam-style mark schemes provided with each task.
- Tasks do vary however, and will include research and experiments that are less formally assessed.
- Each unit concludes with a formal test, completed as homework, which is fully graded by me, with detailed feedback.
- Fully graded mock exams for both Papers 1 and 2 at end of course will be conduct in exam conditions in class, then formally graded.

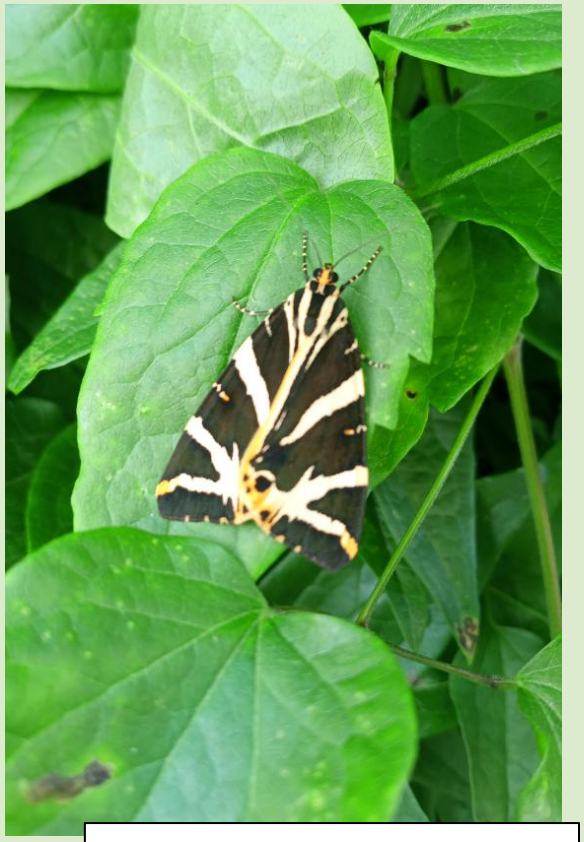
"Jelly ear" fungus
(*Auricularia auricula-judae*)

Holidays and scheduling

- The course starts on Monday June 15th to allow for students sitting other exams.
- As an intensive course, lessons run as normal during school half terms.
- Holidays and break are however essential so the course includes the following breaks:

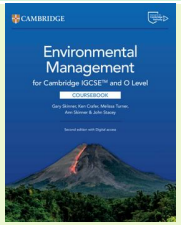
- **Summer break:** No class 24th or 31st August
- **Winter break:** No class 21st or 28th December
- **Spring:** No class 29th March

- Course fees remain the same each month as course cost is calculated over the full year,



Jersey tiger moth
(*Euplagia quadripunctaria*)

Further information

Required skills	• None. An interest in the world around us and the management of our environment and resources is a massive advantage, but can be encouraged ;) • Good literacy skills as well as some basic scientific and mathematical abilities are helpful but not essential
Required equipment	• Access to a camera and mic, even if they choose not to use them • Printer to print off homework and exam papers. • Some way of submitting homework (phone camera/scanner) Full guidance on formatting and submitting homework can be found in the "Homework guidance" doc. • No further equipment is required although calculators should be used in the final exam.
Required textbook:	**Cambridge IGCSE® and O Level Environmental Management Coursebook 2nd edition (Cambridge International IGCSE) (ISBN: 9781009809009)** 
Additional study	• Attending lessons and completing homework is sufficient to pass the course. • Additional study, including reading, watching documentaries and note-taking is extremely important for retaining knowledge and attaining higher grades. • Approximately one hour's additional study per week is advised. • Flashcards can be very useful in remembering key terms!
How parents can help	• Please be ready to encourage your child to keep notes and complete homework. • Environmental Management really benefits from additional study. This can include re-reading notes, re-watching recordings, drawing diagrams, reading news articles and watching related documentaries. • Any opportunity to conduct small experiments and investigations to see these ideas in daily life and in the big wide world also goes a long way!

Please contact Damian at: earthlings.learning@pm.me with any other questions